

*CV & COVER
LETTER
BUILDING*

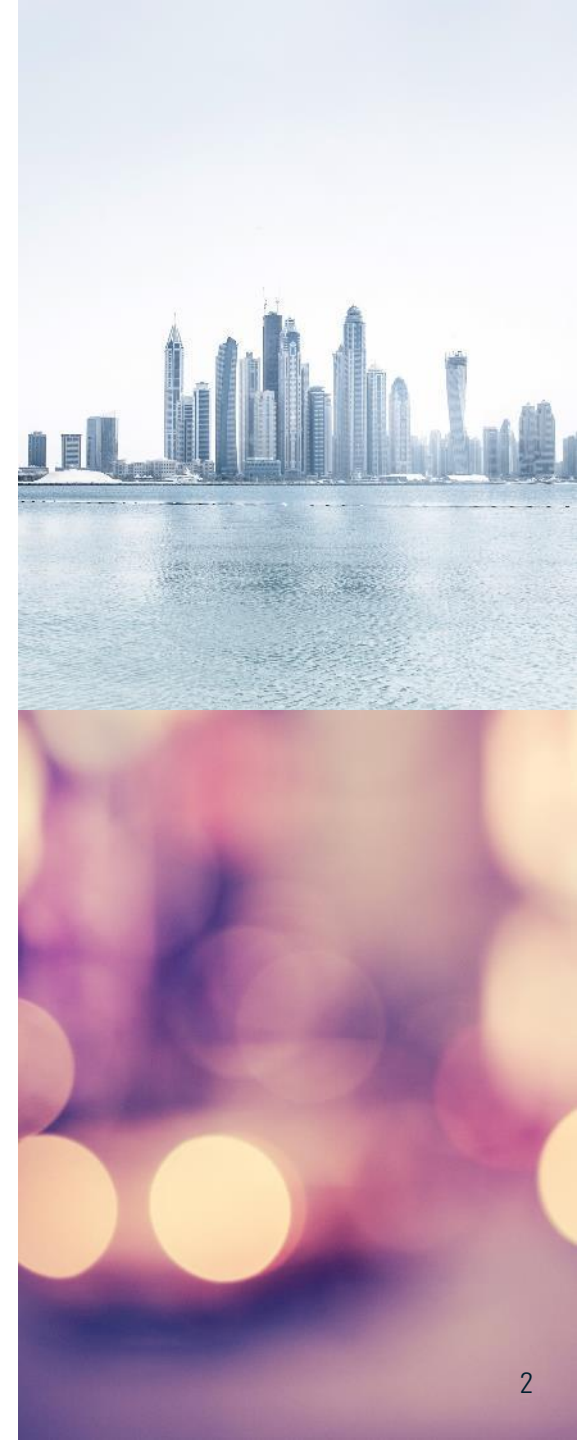
DREAM JOBS UK
启梦咨询



AGENDA

(1) CV

(2) Cover Letter



Topic 1

CV



HOW TO BUILD YOUR CV

BASICS

- 1 page
- Garamond (font)
- 4 sections: Education, Professional Experience, Extracurricular Leadership, Skills & Interests
- **Education:** modules, results, rankings
- **Professional experience:** internships, placements, work experience, research experience
- **Extracurricular leadership:** positions at business societies and sports clubs
- **Skills & interests:** technical skills, awards, qualifications

HOW TO BUILD YOUR CV

ADVANCEMENT

- Audit your skills – **communication, teamwork, leadership, problem-solving, organisation and planning, creativity, IT or other professional skills, commercial awareness, personal qualities**
- Tell a story – what's your journey?
- Make it presentable – good to look at

HOW TO BUILD YOUR CV

MOST USEFUL ACTIVITIES FOR CONSULTING

- **Academic:** no restriction (as long as you're good at it)
- **Professional experience:** Consulting, M&A, Industry, Corporate Development, Start-ups
- **Extracurricular activities:** Corporate Society leadership, Pro-Bono Consulting, Research Assistant
- **Skills:** PowerPoint, Excel
- **Interests:** things that make you stand out e.g. languages, wine tasting

HOW TO BUILD YOUR CV

SPECIFIC SOCIETIES YOU CAN JOIN (AT BAYES)

- <https://www.csqsu.co.uk/community/societies/>
- Consulting Society
- Corporate Finance Society
- Data Science & AI Society
- Finance Society
- Investment Banking Society
- Venture Capital

EDUCATION

Gives expected
result

Explains non-UK
qualification

EDUCATION

BSc. Government and Economics

10/2013 – 06/2018

London School of Economics and Political Science, UK

- Expected Grade: First Class (Honours)
- Dissertation researched the changes to economic public policy and the extent to which the changes were affected by outside influences/institutions from a political science perspective

Singapore GCE 'A' Levels

01/2011 – 12/2012

National Junior College, Singapore

- 9 As including further mathematics, physics and chemistry
- Three distinctions for special papers in mathematics, physics and chemistry
- Highest grades in Singapore

Indian Class 10th

02/1998 – 12/2010

Delhi Public School, R.K.Puram, New Delhi, India

- 93.2% overall including mathematics, English, science and social sciences
- Results in top 2% of year (out of 300 students)

Selects a
relevant
module to
explain

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Talks about
skills,
achievements,
and results

WORK EXPERIENCE

Intern, National Policy on SMEs department 07/2014 – 09/2018
Ministry for Trade and Industry, Singapore

- Developed a revised long-term strategy as part of a team, including deciding on which industry sectors and functional areas to focus development efforts
- Researched and presented results to the team on establishing comparative international benchmarks for Singaporean agencies in the SME sector

Spring Intern, International Team on European Equities 04/2014 – 04/2014
Goldman Sachs, London

- Presented research findings (compiled as part of a team) regarding the equities of a European client, to the client and senior bosses

Customer Assistant 04/2013 – 06/2013
Paris Gourmand, Singapore

- Supervised café and team of assistants in day to day running of the business
- Managed time to ensure efficient but good customer service

Volunteer Mentor 02/2013 – 04/2013
Singapore Indian Development Association

- Managed the programme which coordinates volunteers and mentees and recruits more mentors, as part of a team
- Mentored three children from disadvantaged households, encouraging them to stay in education
- Organised mentor programme through administrative duties

Uses positive,
proactive
language

Quantifies
success with
figures

Explains
organisation
and role
when
necessary

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

VERBS

<https://www.themuse.com/advice/185-powerful-verbs-that-will-make-your-resume-awesome>

OTHER SECTIONS

Gives appropriate level of detail

Quantifies success with figures

Headings are flexible in these sections

Goes into detail about interests

EXTRA CURRICULAR EXPERIENCE	
Secretary London International Model United Nations	10/2014 – present
- Coordinate the weekly meetings of the Organising Committee and ensure timeline requirements are met - Arrange venue and accommodation for over 70 participants	
Secretary LSE Debate Society	10/2014 – 06/2016
- Active member and debater in the LSE Debate Team, representing LSE at inter-varsity tournaments - Organised weekly meetings of the society, coordinating 30 members - Planned, prepared and facilitated the LSE Open 2015, an international inter-varsity competition, attended by 200 contestants	
International Editor The Beaver, LSE's weekly newspaper	10/2014 – 06/2016
Wrote a dedicated column on international affairs	
President National Junior College Debate Club	01/2012 – 12/2012
- Debater in the NJC Debate Team - Liaised with peers to ensure attendance at the Club, with responsibility for over 80 debaters	
AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS	
'Best second year exam performance, with reference to first years' at LSE, out of a possible 2000 students; The CS MacTaggart Prize 2015 - Student of the Year 2013 out of 500 students; National Junior College, Singapore	
IT SKILLS	
- Statistical software packages including eViews, Minitab and Stata - Touch typing ability c. 60 wpm - Proficient in all major Microsoft Office applications, including complex formulae in Excel	
INTERESTS	
Backpacked through Mediterranean Europe for nine weeks, a particular highlight was visiting Florence and experiencing the Uffizi and Accademia museums	

Same layout as work experience

Uses selective examples and explains the significance

Highlights relevant IT skills

AN EXAMPLE

Smaller margins
than two-page CV

Clearly defined
sections

Combines
sections which
might be
separate on a
two-page CV

EDWARD BACKER edwardbacker@gmail.com (+44) 123456789	
EDUCATION	
MSc European Political Economy, London School of Economics • Analysis of the European process of political and economic integration. • Focus on European models of capitalism, Spain and the philosophical rationale of Europe.	2015-2018
BSc (Hons) International Business, 2:1, Warwick Business School • Focused on: International Marketing and Strategy, Latin-American Economies, Service Operations Management and European Political Economy. • Third year spent as Erasmus in Barcelona at ESADE Business School.	2011-2015
European Baccalaureate, 80.84%, ESADE Business & Law School, Luxembourg • French-speaking section, AAB. • Focused on: economics, history, English, Spanish and mathematics.	1999-2011
RELEVANT EXPERIENCE	
Voluntary Work Internship at ADA (Luxembourg) • Analysed the tracking information of the evolution of micro-finance institutions via a rating fund commissioned by the World Bank. • Reported evaluation results through written work on NGOs demanding state funding. • Translated various work including the annual report. • Edited the online bibliography database.	June 2015 – August 2015
Student Work Placement at DuPont de Nemours (Luxembourg) • Created access databases for the Energy department. • Liaised with colleagues to determine important information and data to be included in databases.	July 2014 – August 2014
Administrator at the European Court of Auditors (Luxembourg) • Organised diverse documents in all EU languages.	August 2011
ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE	
Cashier and Steward at the University of Warwick Cinema • Communicated with customers to ensure good customer service.	Sept 2012 – Sept 2013
Student Employment at the European Investment Bank (Luxembourg) • Organised and distributed internal and external mail in two divisions of the bank.	August 2011
LANGUAGES & IT KNOWLEDGE	
• French and Spanish: Native speaker. • English: Fluent. • Catalan: Intermediate. • Greek: Basic, simple comprehension, reading and speaking. • Very good knowledge of MS Word, Excel, Access and Outlook.	
AWARDS & INTERESTS	
• "Diploma Superior de Español" awarded by the Cervantes Institute, 2003. • Tennis: Member of the Warwick team 2011-2012, captain of my hometown team in 2008. • Basketball: Player since the age of 12, member of my hometown team 2004-2007. Hometown council award for basketball achievement, 2004. • Took part in the Close-up Foundation two weeks study tour of the political and social institutions in New York, Philadelphia and Washington DC, 2003.	

Very concise
information

Less white
space on a
single page CV

Topic 2

COVER LETTER



STRUCTURE

STRUCTURE OF THE COVER LETTER

- 1 page
- 3 paragraphs: why me, why consulting, why firm

CONTENT

- ☐ Have you tailored your cover letter to the position and organisation using the job description and person specification?
- ☐ Is your motivation for the specific area, job, and organisation clear?
- ☐ Have you researched the organisation and made a link between yourself and them and how you can meet their needs?
- ☐ Do you use relevant examples to highlight qualifications, experience, strengths, competencies, and achievements?
- ☐ Is the language positive and enthusiastic?
- ☐ If you are changing career direction, have you demonstrated transferable skills and recognised and addressed any skills gaps?
- ☐ Have you checked for vocabulary, grammar, spelling, and punctuation errors?

LAYOUT AND STRUCTURE

- ☐ Have you followed business letter protocol?
- ☐ Have you addressed your cover letter to a specific person (where possible) and signed off appropriately?
 - Dear Ms Smith...Yours sincerely
 - Dear Sir/Madam...Yours faithfully
- ☐ Does your cover letter follow a clear and logical structure; is it easy to scan read?
- ☐ Have you written concise sentences and paragraphs with no more than 400 words/one page of A4 overall?
- ☐ Is your text left aligned or justified and cleanly formatted?
- ☐ Have you used a professional font which is legible (11pt is ideal) and the same style as your CV?

AN EXAMPLE

**Recruiter's
name and
organisation's
address**

**Talks about
education and
work experience
to emphasise
relevant
skills and
achievements**

**Customary sign
off for writing to
a named person.
Use "Yours
faithfully" if you
don't have a
named person
to write to**

Ms J Joseph
Graduate Recruitment Manager
TB4 Consultancy
London WC2R 2LS

22 September 2017

Dear Ms Joseph

I would like to apply for the position of Trainee IT Consultant recently advertised on the LSE Careers vacancy board. I have just started a one year master's course in Information Systems at the London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE).

As you can see from my enclosed CV, I worked during my undergraduate degree at the University of Warwick gaining valuable experience as an IT business analyst with Société Générale and as a volunteer with Peace Way Foundation. At Société Générale, one of my key achievements was to design and implement a company-specific information system which has resulted in a 25% reduction in administration time for the bank. Also, as part of the internship in the New York office, I completed a 60 page report on how a good information system strategy could be developed and implemented by senior managers. Working as a volunteer with the Peace Foundation in Bangkok further developed my cultural awareness and relationship management skills, qualities also relevant to the work of an IT consultant. As well as these qualities, my undergraduate studies have also developed my skills in researching a topic, making presentations, writing reports and analysing data.

One of the main reasons for choosing IT consultancy as a career is that I have for a long time been interested in business but also fascinated by how technology and information systems can improve organisational effectiveness. The variety of working on different projects across different sectors of work also appeals to me. My reasons for applying to TB4 are as follows: First, the range of clients TB4 works with is considerably broader than many of the other major IT consultancy firms that I have been researching. I recently read an article on www.top-consultant.com about the innovative work you have done both in the public and private sectors relating to IT systems mergers and information security, an area I'm very interested in. Secondly, having attended your recent presentation at LSE and having spoken with Jim Bowen, I was impressed by the enthusiasm with which he talked about his work and the many opportunities at TB4 for ambitious graduates.

I am very excited about this opportunity and look forward to discussing my application with you in greater detail. Should you require any further information please get in touch.

Yours sincerely,

Paola Vincent

Paola Vincent
33 Emmengate Street
London
SE12 3PY

**Applicant's
name and
address**

**States clearly
where the
position was
advertised**

**Writes precisely
about why
they want to
work for TB4.
Avoids vague
generalisations**